

FREE HOMEOWNER PLANNING GUIDE

The AmeriDex Project Planning Guide

Seven decisions to make before the joists go up, plus the questions to bring to your builder and a worksheet to capture your plan.

The 7-Step Checklist

Use, layout, framing, drainage, materials, finishes and warranty, in the order they matter.

Builder Questions

What to ask so every quote covers the same complete scope.

Project Worksheet

Dimensions, height, colors and timeline in one place for your quote.

PART 1

The 7-Step Pre-Construction Checklist

Layout, drainage and material choices are easy to change on paper and costly to change once framing is set. Work through these in order and check each one off as you lock it in.

> **Decide this first:** do you want to use the space under the deck? That one answer shapes the drainage choice, the framing details and the finish below.

- [ ] **1 Decide How You Will Use the Space**
  Entertaining, lounging, storage or an outdoor kitchen below. If you want a usable area under a raised deck, plan for it now, because it determines the drainage approach.

- [ ] **2 Confirm Layout, Size and Permits**
  Sketch the footprint, stairs and house attachment. Check setbacks, height limits and permit requirements with your local building department early.

- [ ] **3 Get the Framing Right**
  Framing is the part you cannot see later. With AmeriDex, confirm the frame meets current installation instructions, including the required pitch, board overhang and flashing details.

- [ ] **4 Choose Drainage Before the Boards Go Down** HARD TO REVERSE
  Below-joist systems catch water after it passes through the decking. Above-joist systems stop it higher up. AmeriDex builds the waterproof layer into the deck surface, so rain sheds off before it reaches the framing. It is specified for new construction or a qualifying full re-deck.

- [ ] **5 Choose Your Boards and Seal**
  AmeriDex cellular PVC boards lock onto the Dexerdry seal as they are installed, so the surface you walk on also does the waterproofing. Order free samples early and view colors in daylight against your house.

- [ ] **6 Plan Fasteners, Lighting and the Under-Deck Finish**
  Decide on fastening, and plan lighting, fans or a finished ceiling below before the deck goes down. A much drier area underneath makes those finishes practical.

- [ ] **7 Line Up the Warranty and the Quote**
  AmeriDex carries a 25-year residential limited warranty. Get a written quote that confirms boards, seals, fasteners, accessories, delivery and any installation costs.

Follow current AmeriDex installation instructions. Site conditions matter.

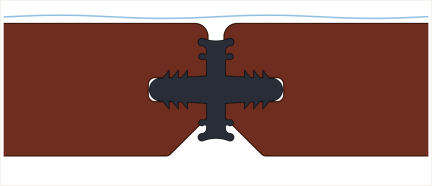
PART 2

Builder Questions and Project Worksheet

Bring this page to your next builder conversation so every quote covers the same complete scope.

Questions to Ask Your Builder

- [ ] Have you installed an above-joist drainage deck before?
- [ ] How will the frame be pitched so water moves to the deck edge?
- [ ] How will the ledger, perimeter and drip edge be flashed?
- [ ] Does the quote include boards, seal, fasteners and trim?
- [ ] What is included for railing, stairs and the ceiling below?
- [ ] Who handles permits and inspections?
- [ ] What is the start date, and how long will the build take?
- [ ] Who registers the warranty after install?



Board plus seal. The Dexerdry seal closes the gap between boards so rain sheds off the surface. Open sides can still admit wind-driven rain.

My Project

WIDTH (FT) _____ DEPTH (FT) _____

HEIGHT OFF THE GROUND

☐ Under 8 ft ☐ 8 to 12 ft ☐ 12 ft or more

PROJECT TYPE

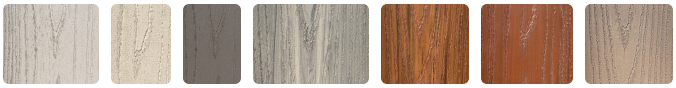
☐ New construction ☐ Full re-deck ☐ Not sure

SPACE BELOW WILL BE

☐ Outdoor kitchen ☐ Lounge ☐ Play area

☐ Storage

COLORS TO SAMPLE



Driftwood Khaki Slate Beachwood Chestnut Redwood Hazelnut

TARGET BUILD WINDOW

☐ Within 3 months ☐ 3 to 6 months

☐ 6 to 12 months

BUILDER OR DEALER

_____

NOTES

_____

_____

Ready for the Next Step?

Request free color samples or a written project quote at ameridex.com.

800-217-9206

sales@ameridex.com